

Five seconds. Then it pulls the plug.

Our service crashed for thousands of users, and the stack trace blamed a line that does nothing wrong.

It only happened on cheap phones. That was the clue.

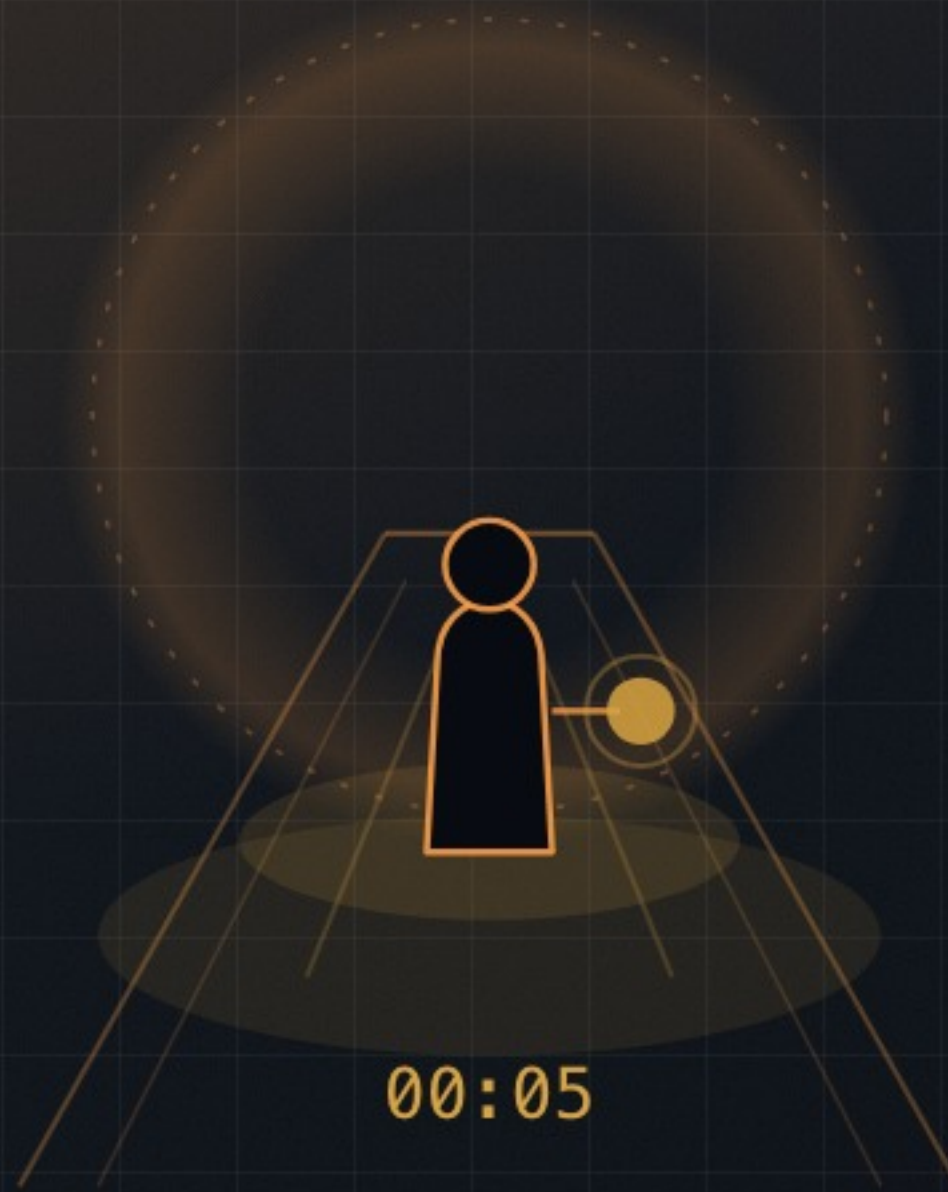
5s

00:05



// THE CAST

It runs the night shift



DOZE THE JAILER

exhibit 04

```
startForeground()
```

It gives you about five seconds to explain why your work belongs, then closes the cell. Not cruel. Just running the prison by the book.

Five seconds spent before the promise

●●● TripTrackingService.kt

```
override fun onStartCommand(...): Int {  
    val trip = tripStore.restoreLastTrip() // disk  
    val config = settings.load()           // more io  
    startForeground(ID, notify(trip, config))  
    return START_STICKY  
}
```

The countdown starts at startForegroundService().

On a cold, loaded phone those two reads blow past the window, and the system kills the service before you ever keep the promise.



Working the night shift

01 startForeground() first
before any init, permission read or coroutine

02 Then do the slow work
warm-up, GPS, network, all of it after

03 Test in Doze
adb shell dumpsys deviceidle force-idle

04 Cheap devices are the truth
a cold, loaded phone is your real deadline



The platform is not out to get you

It is protecting the user's battery and attention from apps that want to run forever.

Post your notification first, work with the lifecycle, and it leaves you alone.

